

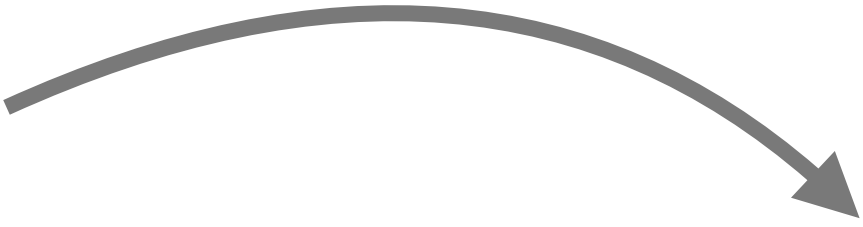
As elsewhere, Edwards is using “necessary” to mean “something we don’t have any choice about.” What does it mean for two things to be **indissolubly** connected?

“3. It is also very manifest, that those things which are indissolubly connected with other things that are necessary, are themselves necessary.”

1. We have no choice about
past facts.

2. In the past, God had foreknowledge of our future actions.

3. We have no choice about God's knowing that in the future I will perform a certain action. (1,2)





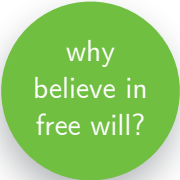
The idea is that the connection is not possible to break — it is, in terms familiar from the cosmological argument, a **necessary connection**.



two
arguments
against free
will



is fate
real?



why
believe in
free will?



three
ways out

As elsewhere, Edwards is using 'necessary' to mean 'something we don't have any

choice about.' What does it mean for two things to be indistinguishable?



1. We have no idea about

parasitiforms.



acai.ios.

2. In the past, God had

for knowledge of future



the future I will perform

God's knowing that in

act in action (1,2)

3. We have no idea about

from the modal argument, a necessary connection.

The idea is that the connection is not possible to break — it is, in terms familiar

first let's think about how Edwards'

responding to Edwards' argument. But

We'll shortly consider some ways of

for fatalsn.

argument might be related to an argument

Edwards' argument — but did believe that

there were truths about all our future

similar to Edwards' argument?

actions. Could they give an argument

God— and hence rejected premise (2) of

Suppose that someone did not believe in

replace reference to God's foreknowledge

with reference to the being of truth about

God only shows up in premises (2) and

(5) Let's look at what happens if we

our future actions.





perform a certain action (1,2)

2*In the past, there were truths about

all of our activities.

that if it is true that I will perform

then we have the choice about q.

4. If we have no choice about p , and no

1. We have no direct facts.

choice about the fact that if p , then q ,

God knows that in the future I will

5* We have noticed that the fact

0 We have achieved what we

acaioid.

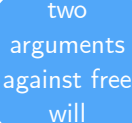
3 We have not at the fact that

some action, then I will prefer that

(3, 4, 5)

will perform various actions.

The fatalist argument



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So now consider a possible scenario in which someone exactly like you would get

never had any. So they lacked free will before getting a Predicto.

a Predictor. By the above line of thought, this person would lack free will. But

that Predict did not **take away** their free will; it just shows them that they

either.

But this person was stipulated to be exactly like you. So you don't have free will,

So far we've looked at two imaginary thought experiments—the story of Osmo,

things as fate, then there is no free will.

and the example of the Predictor — which seem to show that if there is such a

Our question is: do either fatigue or foreknowledge pose a

serious challenge to the reality of free will?

freedom that comes from fate.

Our first topic today is the oldest challenge to the existence of free will: the challenge to



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3. We have no choice about God's knowing that in the future I will perform a certain action. (1,2)



from the causal argument, a necessary connection.